

VALENCIA STARR

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

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SUMMARY

Software engineer with hands-on experience building and deploying full-stack, mobile, and cloud applications using Java, JavaScript, React, Spring Boot, Flask, and Node.js. Proven ability to design REST APIs, implement authentication/authorization, and ship production systems supporting 500-1,000+ users. Combines strong CS fundamentals (B.S. Computer Science, 3.8 GPA) with recent experience training developers on modern engineering practices.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, JavaScript, Python, PHP, SQL

Frontend: React, Next.js, Angular, HTML, CSS, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap, jQuery

Backend: Node.js, Express, Flask, Spring Boot, REST APIs

Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite, MongoDB, Oracle

Cloud & Tools: AWS (Lambda, SNS), Google Cloud Platform, Okta, Git/GitHub, Figma, Render

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Instructor (seasonal) May 2026 - Present

The Knowledge House | Bronx, NY

- Designing and delivering full-stack application curriculum covering HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and Bootstrap, including hands-on code reviews and architecture guidance for student-built web applications.

Computer Science Adjunct Lecturer (seasonal) July 2025 - August 2025

CUNY College of Staten Island | Staten Island, NY

- Built and deployed a grade management system using Express, REST APIs, and Render, integrating database persistence to demonstrate scalable full-stack architecture.
- Directed development of student applications using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and the Fetch API, achieving a 100% project completion rate through structured code reviews and debugging support.
- Guided version control and collaborative development workflows using Git and GitHub.

Technical Instructor (seasonal) June 2025 - August 2025

The Knowledge House | Bronx, NY

- Built a responsive interactive web application (visual novel) using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, achieving a 90%+ completion rate across 60+ student-built projects.
- Prototyped application interfaces in Figma prior to development and guided deployment and presentation workflows.

Software Engineering Instructor November 2022 - September 2023

Flatiron School | New York, NY

- Built and deployed a full-stack course management system using React, Flask, and role-based authentication/authorization, supporting dynamic multi-user workflows.
- Developed backend APIs and interactive web features to support capstone-level applications.
- Managed projects using Git and GitHub, including branching strategy, code review, and merge conflict resolution across team environments.
- Supported system design and debugging for group and capstone projects.

Technical Instructor (seasonal) July 2019 - February 2020

The Knowledge House | Bronx, NY

- Built a responsive interactive web application (visual novel) using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and Bootstrap, achieving a 90%+ student project completion rate.
- Prototyped application interfaces in Figma prior to development to guide UI/UX planning.

Web/Android Developer Intern - Change Food for Good (contract) April 2019 - December 2019

The Knowledge House | Bronx, NY

- Designed and deployed an Android application supporting 1,000+ users, enabling farmers to track crop data and visualize trends via graphs over time.
- Implemented user authentication (account creation, login, logout, session management) and integrated REST API endpoints to deliver user-specific crop data.
- Built Node.js-based web interfaces for training, hosting, and event enrollment.

Web Developer Instructor - Independent Contractor June 2017 - June 2018

NAN Technology Academy | New York, NY

- Built and deployed an inventory management system using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript for the UI, PHP for server-side rendering, and AWS for deployment, training 4+ adult learners on full-stack web development.

Software Developer Intern July 2016 - August 2016

Revature | Reston, VA

- Built an employment reimbursement system using Java, JavaScript, Bootstrap, and Oracle DBMS, supporting 500+ employees and 100+ managers with request submission and manager approval workflows.
- Designed backend logic and database queries for processing reimbursement requests.
- Built a reusable Java email-sending library for integration across team applications.

Full-Stack Developer Intern September 2014 - January 2015

CUNY City College (LSAMP) | New York, NY

- Built full-stack features (forms, search, automated email notifications) using PHP, MySQL, HTML, CSS, and jQuery for a research-application platform supporting 500+ users.
- Built administrative tools for managing applications, broadcast emails, and communications.

PROJECTS

Animals and Nature - Admin Dashboard github.com/starrv/animals-and-nature

2024 - Present

- Built an administrator dashboard using Spring Boot, MongoDB, AWS Lambda, AWS SNS, and Next.js to manage platform users and content.
- Migrated authentication from Okta to Auth0 (June 2026), updating the authorization flow and integration across the dashboard.

Animals and Nature - Message Board github.com/starrv/animals-and-nature

2016 - 2024

- Built and maintained a message board supporting 1,000+ users using PHP, jQuery, Bootstrap, and MySQL, with account creation and threaded discussions.

Find Princess Angela

2015 - Present

- Built and published a 3D adventure video game in Java, implementing game logic, character movement, and level design; actively developing additional levels and features for the current version.

Let's Chat github.com/starrv/ChatClient

2014 - 2024

- Built and periodically enhanced a Java group-chat application supporting up to 50 concurrent users, with end-to-end message encryption and private/broadcast messaging.

Let's Paint github.com/starrv/paint

2014 - 2024

- Built and periodically enhanced a Java graphics editor supporting drawing, text, create/save/print, and undo/redo, with an integrated music playback feature.

EDUCATION

CUNY Lehman College — B.S. Computer Science, GPA 3.8, Departmental Honors

Bronx, NY | May 2015

Union College — B.S. Mathematics

Schenectady, NY | June 2009